

Part III

CIVIC LITERACY ESSAY (Questions 31–37)

This Civic Literacy Essay Question is based on the accompanying documents. The question is designed to test your ability to work with historical documents. Some of these documents have been edited for the purpose of this question. As you analyze the documents, take into account the source of each document and any point of view that may be presented in the document. Keep in mind that the language and images used in a document may reflect the historical context of the time in which it was created.

Historical Context: Prohibition

Throughout United States history, many constitutional and civic issues have been debated by Americans. These debates have resulted in efforts by individuals, groups, and governments to address these issues. These efforts have achieved varying degrees of success. One of these constitutional and civic issues is *Prohibition*.

Task: Read and analyze the documents in Part A. Using information from the documents and your knowledge of United States history, answer the questions that follow each document in Part A. Your answers to the questions will help you write the Part B essay in which you will be asked to

- Describe the historical circumstances surrounding this constitutional or civic issue
- Explain efforts by individuals, groups, and/or governments to address this constitutional or civic issue
- Discuss the impact of the efforts on the United States and/or on American society

In developing your answers to Part III, be sure to keep these general definitions in mind:

- (a) **describe** means “to illustrate something in words or tell about it”
- (b) **explain** means “to make plain or understandable; to give reasons for or causes of; to show the logical development or relationships of”
- (c) **discuss** means “to make observations about something using facts, reasoning, and argument; to present in some detail”

Civic Literacy Essay

Part A

Short-Answer Questions (31–36)

Directions: Analyze the documents and answer the short-answer questions that follow each document in the space provided.

Document 1

. . . The prohibition movement was an outgrowth of the temperance crusades of the first half of the nineteenth century. Hard drinking was almost the rule among the Fathers of the Republic. The per capita consumption of spirits in the early days was many times what it is now, and beer drinking was almost unknown. After the War of 1812, there grew up in the New England States a large commerce in West Indian rum, which was consumed extensively, especially in Maine, supplementing the consumption of heavy liquors which were manufactured in those States. Maine alone, in 1827, when her population was 360,000, manufactured 1,333,160 gallons of liquor, and it was sold at retail in nearly every store and tavern. Drunkenness in its worst form, involving disastrous social consequences, was widespread. Sufficient evidence of it was to be found in the number of persons in the jails and poorhouses. . . .

Source: L. Ames Brown, "Prohibition," *The North American Review*, November 1915

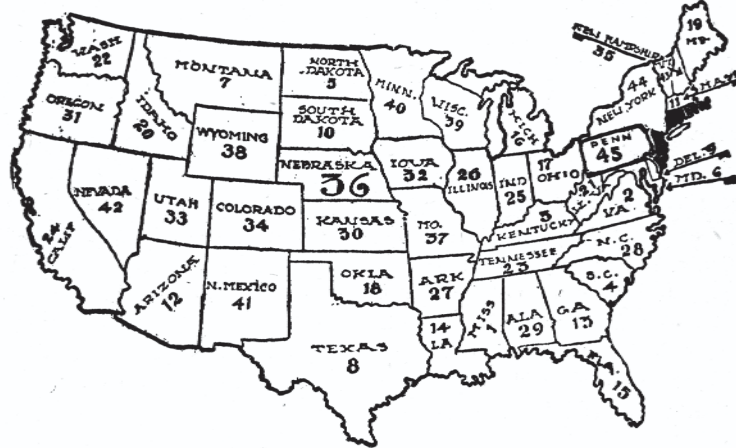
31 According to L. Ames Brown, what is **one** historical circumstance surrounding the issue of Prohibition? [1]

Score	
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National Prohibition

RATIFICATION MAP

Numbers Indicate Order in which States have Ratified the National Prohibition Amendment



This map shows on this date, January 31, 1919, that there are yet only four states which have not ratified. Three of these, Pennsylvania, Connecticut and Rhode Island, are expected to ratify at an early date. Even New Jersey may ratify and make the result unanimous.

STATEMENT OF THE NATIONAL LEGISLATIVE COMMITTEE OF THE ANTI-SALOON LEAGUE OF AMERICA

The ratification of the Prohibition amendment to the constitution is the consummation of more than twenty-five years of effort on the part of the Anti-Saloon League, representing as it has the moral and religious forces of the nation. It is the greatest victory for moral reform in America since the Declaration of Independence.

Not less in importance to that which has already been accomplished is the vitally essential task now before the Prohibition forces of securing from Congress and the states proper enforcement legislation and the crystallizing of public sentiment in the large cities and wet districts for complete enforcement of the law.

With Prohibition assured for this nation, the American anti-liquor forces need to redouble their efforts for the larger task of world Prohibition of the manufacture and sale of all intoxicating beverages.

James Cannon, Jr.,
Wayne B. Wheeler,
Arthur J. Barton,
Ernest H. Cierington,
Legislative Committee.

P. A. Baker, General Superintendent.
E. C. Dinwiddie, Legislative Superintendent.

Source: Anti-Saloon League of America, 1919

32 According to this poster, what is **one** historical circumstance surrounding the issue of Prohibition? [1]

Score

Document 3

. . . Over his first three years in the White House Hoover never wavered in his support for Prohibition. In 1929 he signed the “Five and Ten Law” making every liquor violation a felony, and his Justice Department ramped up federal enforcement. “We enormously increased the jail population,” by jailing Prohibition violators Hoover recalled in his memoirs. “We multiplied the fines, padlocking, and confiscations.” Yet all this aggressive action he ascribed [attributed] to his duty as a constitutional officer, not to his actual endorsement. On this basic political question, Hoover declined to share his feelings and refused to act on them. . . .

During the 1928 campaign Hoover famously saluted Prohibition as “a great social and economic experiment, noble in motive and far-reaching in purpose.” But three years later, surely the test had been run. . . .

By early 1932 little doubt remained as to the mood of the electorate. Respondents to a national mail-in survey conducted by *The Literary Digest* in February and March endorsed repeal of the Eighteenth Amendment by a four-to-one margin. Residents of Ohio, the birthplace of Prohibition, sent in 112,026 ballots for repeal and just 43,284 for keeping the ban on booze. Kansas was the only state to poll in favor of Prohibition. . . .

Source: Charles Rappleye, *Herbert Hoover in the White House*, Simon & Schuster, 2016 (adapted)

33 Based on this document, what was **one** effort to address the issue of Prohibition? [1]

Score

Document 4

... The Women's Organization for National Prohibition Reform (WONPR) was founded in 1929 to show that not all women supported temperance. New York socialite Pauline Sabin led the charge after hearing Ella Boole, the Brooklyn-based leader of the Women's Christian Temperance Union, declare that her support for Prohibition represented "the women of America." On the heels of the successful suffrage campaign that won women the right to vote in 1920, the WONPR, and Sabin in particular, reflected the modern "new woman" of the 1920s. Many members of the WONPR had in fact initially supported the 18th amendment. But they had come to believe that Prohibition had led to a surge in unregulated and particularly underage drinking, as well as a growing sense of distrust for the rule of law. The WONPR's opposition to Prohibition, just like the 18th amendment itself, was not only about drinking, but about the government's role in regulating behavior.

The WONPR did a lot of what we think of now as typical political campaign activities: members attended meetings and gave speeches at rallies, went door-to-door to recruit new supporters, used new technology to spread their message—at the time radio, and lobbied politicians. Wealthy women had founded the organization, and proved able to raise funds even after the Stock Market Crash of 1929 ushered in the Great Depression. From its headquarters in New York City, the organization also gained publicity by organizing events such as a motorcade through New York State. . . .

Source: Sarah Seidman, "The New York Women Who Dismantled Prohibition,"
Museum of the City of New York, December 15, 2015

34 According to Sarah Seidman, what was **one** effort to address Prohibition? [1]

Score

Document 5

. . . The end of the Prohibition era marked the demise of a moral crusade meant to impose a uniform standard of social behavior in the United States. Unrealistic and unforgiving, Prohibition had allowed a vocal minority to regulate the personal habits of all Americans, especially those who lived and worked in cities like New York. While the desire of the dry crusade to uplift and improve the United States by banning alcohol and the saloon had in some ways been understandable in the Progressive era that spawned the Prohibition movement, the shortcomings of the dry crusade manifested themselves as soon as the dry experiment had begun. Anachronistic [outdated] and unworkable, the Prohibition experiment was ill suited to the diversity and dynamic of the modern United States, which by the 1920s had grown too large and too varied a nation to be governed by an impulse as intrusive as the dry crusade. Despite the force of federal law, the use of authoritarian tactics to enforce it, and the expenditure of millions of dollars a year, in fourteen years Prohibition succeeded neither in changing Americans' behavior nor in eliminating the problems caused by alcohol abuse. When Prohibition failed, and it did so spectacularly, it revealed the limits of moral reform movements, and specifically the paternalistic, prejudiced, and undemocratic ideals behind the dry crusade. . . .

Source: Michael A. Lerner, *Dry Manhattan: Prohibition in New York City*, Harvard University Press, 2007

35 According to Michael A. Lerner, what has been **one** impact of the efforts to address Prohibition? [1]

Score

Document 6

Although President Franklin Roosevelt supported repeal of Prohibition, he wanted to ban the operation of saloons, bars, and taverns in the United States.

New York Times.

LATE CITY EDITION

WEATHER—Rain and warmer today; tomorrow fair and colder. Temperatures Yesterday—Max., 41; min., 34.

Copyright, 1933, by The New York Times Company.

NEW YORK, WEDNESDAY, DECEMBER 6, 1933. M P TWO CENTS In New York City. CHECK UP—(4) FOUR CENTS Elsewhere Except Alaska and Hawaii. In U.S. and 10c Postal Zone

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PROHIBITION REPEAL IS RATIFIED AT 5:32 P. M.; ROOSEVELT ASKS NATION TO BAR THE SALOON; NEW YORK CELEBRATES WITH QUIET RESTRAINT

State House Bootlegger Is Barred in Maryland

Special to THE NEW YORK TIMES.
ANNAPOLIS, Md., Dec. 5.—Wet legislators here will patriotically support legal liquor. The State House bootlegger received formal notice today to discontinue his trade. The notice was served by a policeman on duty at the Capitol.

Throughout this session, the bootlegger has conducted a thriving business; a business which, he says, has been especially arduous because of the sudden demands made on him by legislators and their desire for prompt service.

While his services were cut off eight hours before post-prohibition stuff could be bought, the bootlegger thought the legislators had obtained a sufficient reserve to carry them through until evening and legal liquor.

CITY TOASTS NEW ERA

Crowds Swamp Licensed Resorts, but the Legal Liquor Is Scarce.

CELEBRATION IN STREETS

Marked by Absence of Undue Hilarity and Only Normal Number of Arrests.

MANY SPEAKEASIES CLOSE

Machine Guns Guard Some Liquor Trucks—Supplies to Be Rushed Out Today.

The Repeal Proclamation

Special to THE NEW YORK TIMES.
WASHINGTON, Dec. 5.—The text of the proclamation by William Phillips, Acting Secretary of State, certifying to the adoption of the Twenty-first Amendment repealing prohibition, follows:

WILLIAM PHILLIPS,
Acting Secretary of State of the United States of America.

To all whom these presents shall come, greeting:

KNOW YE, That the Congress of the United States, at the second session, Seventy-second Congress, begun and held at the city of Washington on Monday, the fifth day of December, in the year one thousand nine hundred and thirty-two, passed a joint Resolution in the words and figures as follows:

To wit—

JOINT RESOLUTION.

Proposing an amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

Resolved by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled (two-thirds of each House concurring therein), That the following article is hereby proposed as an amendment to the Constitution of the United States, which shall be valid to all intents and purposes as part of the Constitution when ratified by conventions in three-fourths of the several States:

FINAL ACTION AT CAPITAL

President Proclaims the Nation's New Policy as Utah Ratifies.

PHILLIPS SIGNS DECREE

Orders 21st Amendment in Effect on Receiving Votes of Three Final States.

RECOVERY TAXES TO END

\$227,000,000 a Year Automatically Dropped—Canadian Whisky Quota Is Raised.

RATIFYING BY UTAH ENDS PROHIBITION

Source: New York Times, December 6, 1933

36 Based on this document, what is **one** impact of the efforts to address Prohibition? [1]

Score

U.S. Hist. & Gov't. – Jan. '26

[30]

Part B

Civic Literacy Essay Question (37)

Directions: Write a well-organized essay that includes an introduction, several paragraphs, and a conclusion. Use evidence from *at least four* documents in the body of the essay. Support your response with relevant facts, examples, and details. Include additional outside information.

Historical Context: Prohibition

Throughout United States history, many constitutional and civic issues have been debated by Americans. These debates have resulted in efforts by individuals, groups, and governments to address these issues. These efforts have achieved varying degrees of success. One of these constitutional and civic issues is *Prohibition*.

Task: Using information from the documents and your knowledge of United States history, write an essay in which you

- Describe the historical circumstances surrounding this constitutional or civic issue
- Explain efforts by individuals, groups, and/or governments to address this constitutional or civic issue
- Discuss the impact of the efforts on the United States and/or on American society

Guidelines:

In your essay, be sure to

- Develop all aspects of the task
- Explain *at least two* efforts to address the issue
- Incorporate information from *at least four* documents
- Incorporate relevant outside information
- Support the theme with relevant facts, examples, and details
- Use a logical and clear plan of organization, including an introduction and a conclusion that are beyond a restatement of the theme